

ZAREF MOHAMMED

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

- Business development-oriented media professional with strong regional market access in the Middle East, combining journalism, media consultancy, and cross-border commercial experience. More than seven years of experience working with leading international media outlets and Chinese partners, supporting Chinese companies as they enter the UAE and Gulf markets. Experienced in coordinating with local stakeholders
- Proven ability to build partnerships, develop advertiser and institutional relationships, and support market entry strategies for Chinese media platforms and corporations in the Middle East. Extensive network across Arab media institutions, digital platforms, journalists, influencers, and content producers. Strong cross-cultural negotiation, stakeholder management, and strategic communication capabilities.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Partner Outreach (China-UAE / GCC) • Government & Stakeholder Liaison
- Regional Market Strategy (Middle East/ Market Entry Support for Chinese Companies)
- Commercial Proposals & Bidding Documents
- Cross-border Cooperation Models
- Stakeholder & Ecosystem Mapping
- Media Relations & Institutional Relations
- Data-driven Performance Analysis
- Cross-cultural Negotiation
- Strategic Communications

SOCIAL SERVICE ACTIVES:

Media & Market Access Consultant – China-Middle East (Freelance) | 2019 – Present | based UAE & Syria

Advise Chinese companies seeking visibility and opportunities in the UAE and wider Gulf region, with a focus on technology, mobility and investment projects.

Provide Arabic- and English-language media coverage, PR support and basic market- introduction content for Chinese clients.

Coordinate with event organizers, business councils and other intermediaries to facilitate Chinese participation in UAE-based forums, exhibitions and roadshows.

Use journalistic research skills to prepare background briefs on local policies, public sentiment and sector trends relevant to clients' projects.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

Chinese Arabic TV (CATV) | 2022 – 2025 Reporter & Media Development Consultant

Reported on economic and political developments in the Middle East, with frequent focus on China–Arab cooperation.

Produced concise news stories and features that explained complex topics such as trade, investment and regional projects to a broad Arabic-speaking audience.

Worked closely with editors and producers from China, strengthening cross-cultural communication and remote coordination skills.

CGTN Arabic | 2018 – 2022 Photojournalist, Video Editor & Assistant Correspondent

Supported field reporting and coverage of key regional events, including high-level visits, economic conferences and infrastructure projects.

Coordinated with local authorities, press offices and event organizers to secure access, permissions and interviews.

Produced visual stories that highlighted China–Middle East ties, building detailed knowledge of regional dynamics.

Associated Press (AP) | 2018 – 2021 Freelance Photojournalist & Media Consultant

Produced verified visual content for international audiences in fast-moving and sensitive environments.

Worked under strict deadlines, maintaining accuracy, professionalism and calm decision-making.

Collaborated remotely with international editors, strengthening communication and coordination skills.

EDUCATION:

Bachelor's Degree in Economics – Statistics | Tishreen University, Syria | 2014

Additional academic and professional training in Media, Communications, and Public Relations.

LANGUAGES:

Arabic: Native

English: Very Good

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

Excel | PowerPoint | Word | Media Analytics Tools